

Electron clouds

In modern models of the atom, electrons are not solid spheres orbiting a nucleus at a fixed distance. Instead, they are represented as clouds in which electrons are most likely to be found if looked for.

There is an electromagnetic attraction between negatively charged electrons and positively charged protons in the nucleus.

ATTRACTION

QUANTUM MODEL

In the atom, the number of negatively charged electrons balances out the number of positive protons in the nucleus.

ELECTRONS

Clouds of various shapes represent the orbitals in which electrons are most likely to be found.

ELECTRON CLOUD